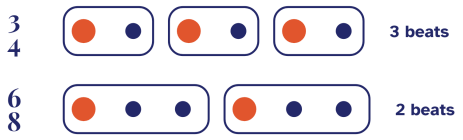
TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · LEARN

Compound and irregular time

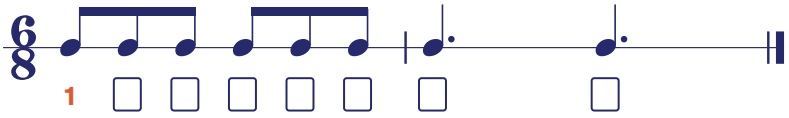


REMEMBER In 6/8 each beat is a dotted crotchet, split into three: count 1 2 3 4 5 6, feel two.

1 Count 6/8

★☆☆

Write a count in every box. The first is done.



2 3/4 or 6/8?

★★☆

Both bars hold six quavers. Look at the beams and write the time signature. The first is done.



time signature **3/4**

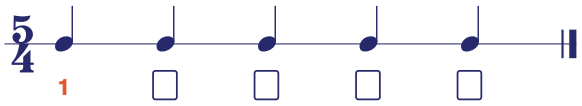


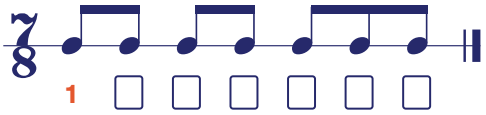
time signature _____

3 Uneven bars

★★☆

Count 5/4 as 3 + 2 and 7/8 as 2 + 2 + 3: write the count in every box. The first of each is done.





4 Beats in compound time

★☆☆

Complete each line: how many dotted-crotchet beats in a bar? The first is done.

6/8	**2**	beats
9/8		beats
12/8		beats

5 Feel two

★☆☆

Clap six quavers counting 1 2 3 4 5 6, then clap again saying only “1” and “4”. Tick a circle each time the two beats feel steady.

Date _____

TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · USE

Compound and irregular time

REMEMBER Many dances keep 4/4 but group its eight quavers 3 + 3 + 2.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

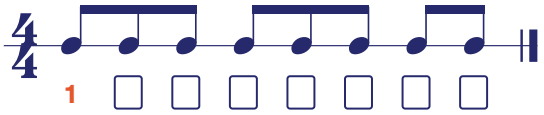
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 3 + 3 + 2 ★★☆

Write the count in every box (1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2), then tap it, louder on each 1. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count ★★☆

Clap with a metronome, counting six quavers, feeling two beats. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a piece in 6/8		☐
a bar of quavers beamed in threes		☐
a piece in 5/4 or 7/8 (listen: Take Five)		☐

Date _____